Residents Annual Report 2010

2009/10

Gallions Housing Association

Welcome

This Annual Report contains our key performance facts and figures from 1st April 2009 to 31st March 2010. We always monitor our results to make sure we are delivering our services to the best possible standard.

This year has been a challenging time for many housing associations and developers as we have seen budgets cut and building work slow down. In spite of these set backs we have been continuing to work to change our communities for the better.

In April the Tenant Services Authority (TSA) became our regulator and introduced a new range of standards that we must meet. Some of these are based on finding out what our residents want locally (called local offers) and over the last few months we have been asking your views.

The offers cover the following services:

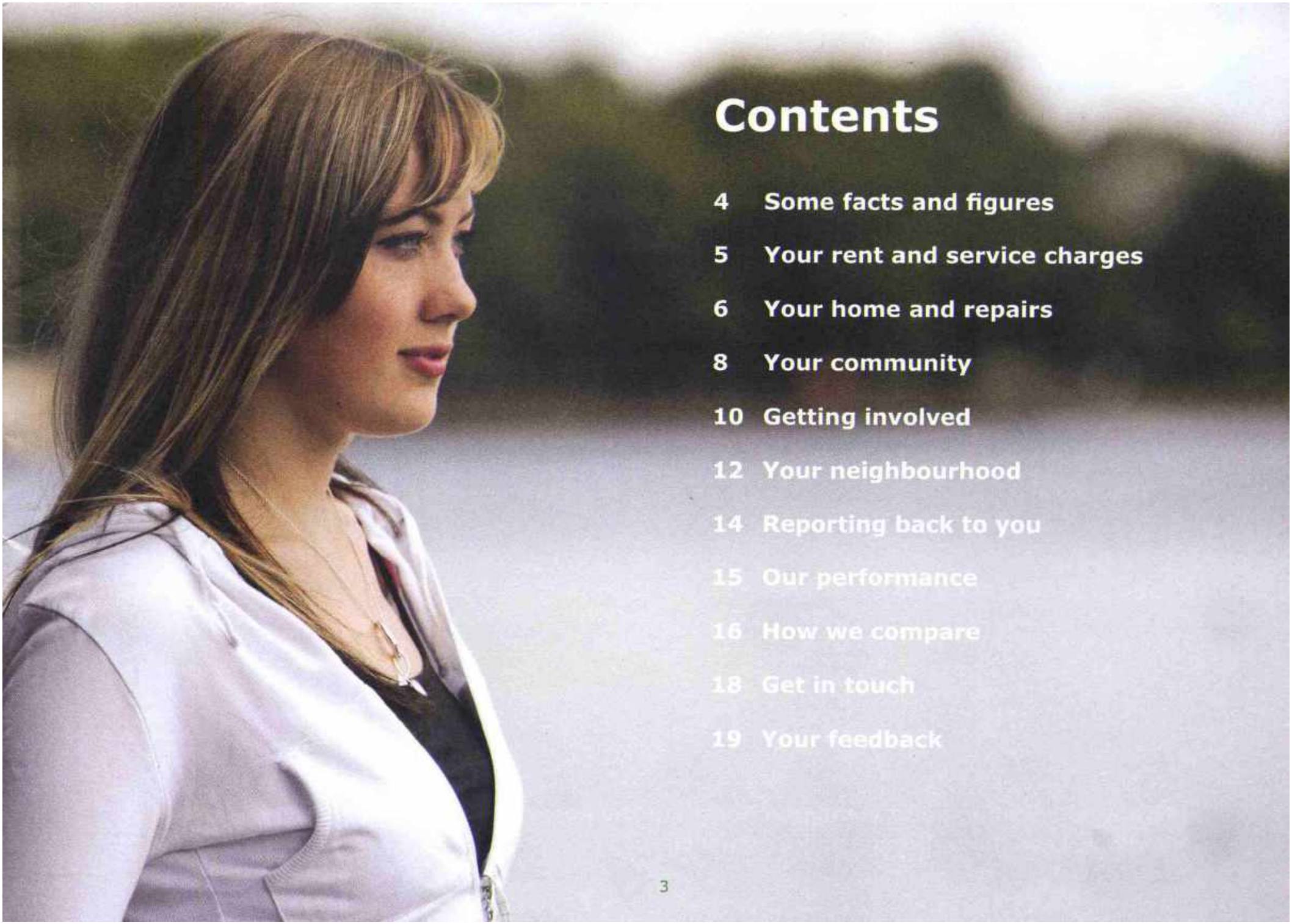
- Your home and repairs
- Your community
- Getting involved
- Your neighbourhood

Throughout the booklet you will see a summary of the offers that we have consulted on. All of the offers detailed in this booklet will be in place by 1st April 2011. Next year we will report back to you, as well as to the TSA, about how we have got on.

We will be working with residents and other agencies to put the offers in place. You can be part of the team that measures these services and it would be great if you would like to get involved.

To find out more about the local offers and to download a full version of our offers document please visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or call us on 0800 83 84 81.

Tony Cotter, Chief Executive



Contents

4 Some facts and figures

5 Your rent and service charges

6 Your home and repairs

8 Your community

10 Getting involved

12 Your neighbourhood

14 Reporting back to you

15 Our performance

16 How we compare

18 Get in touch

19 Your feedback

Some facts and figures

This year Gallions took ownership of 313 new homes:

- 234 Rented
- 12 Shared ownership
- 67 Rent to HomeBuy

In total we now manage:

- 5075 Rented homes
- 396 Leasehold homes
- 315 Shared ownership homes
- 122 Other homes (including market rent)

Types of rented homes we manage:

• 4 beds +	615
• 3 beds	1138
• 2 beds	1341
• 1 bed	1922
• Bedsits	59

This year we helped over 759 new households move into rented homes.

How our rented homes were allocated:

• Internal Transfers	125
• Local Authority Nominations	583
• Other	51

Ethnicity of Gallions tenants

White	60%
Black & Black British	27%
Asian & Asian British	4%
Chinese	1%
Mixed	3%
Other	3%
Unknown	0%
Refused to state	2%

We are now building and managing homes in the boroughs of Tower Hamlets, Newham, Lewisham, Bexley and Greenwich.

Your rent and service charges

The rent money that we collect from you each year gives us the income to provide the best services possible for you and your family, as well as helping us to introduce community improvements.

There are many ways in which you can pay your rent and service charges including direct debit, payment card and online at www.gallionsha.co.uk

This year we have:

- Collected £25,229,991 in rent and service charges
- Issued 650 notices for final rent demands
- Evicted 51 tenants for non payment of their rent or serious rent arrears
- Had an average re-let period of 34 days
- Carried out 198 benefit health checks to help residents claim their correct entitlement

How your rent was collected

Housing Benefit	51.5%
Bank transfer	30.6%
Direct debit	10.6%
Credit/debit card	5.1%
Swipe card	1.2%
Other	1.0%

Average rent per week

Bedsit	£61.40
One bed	£68.69
Two bed	£80.92
Three bed	£94.67
Four bed	£103.66
Five bed	£110.78

For more information about how your rent is calculated please see the information sheet on our website.

Your home and repairs

This year we continued with our home improvement programme as well as carrying out repairs when you told us that something needed to be fixed. Most of our expenditure each year is on improving homes to ensure they are the best they can be.

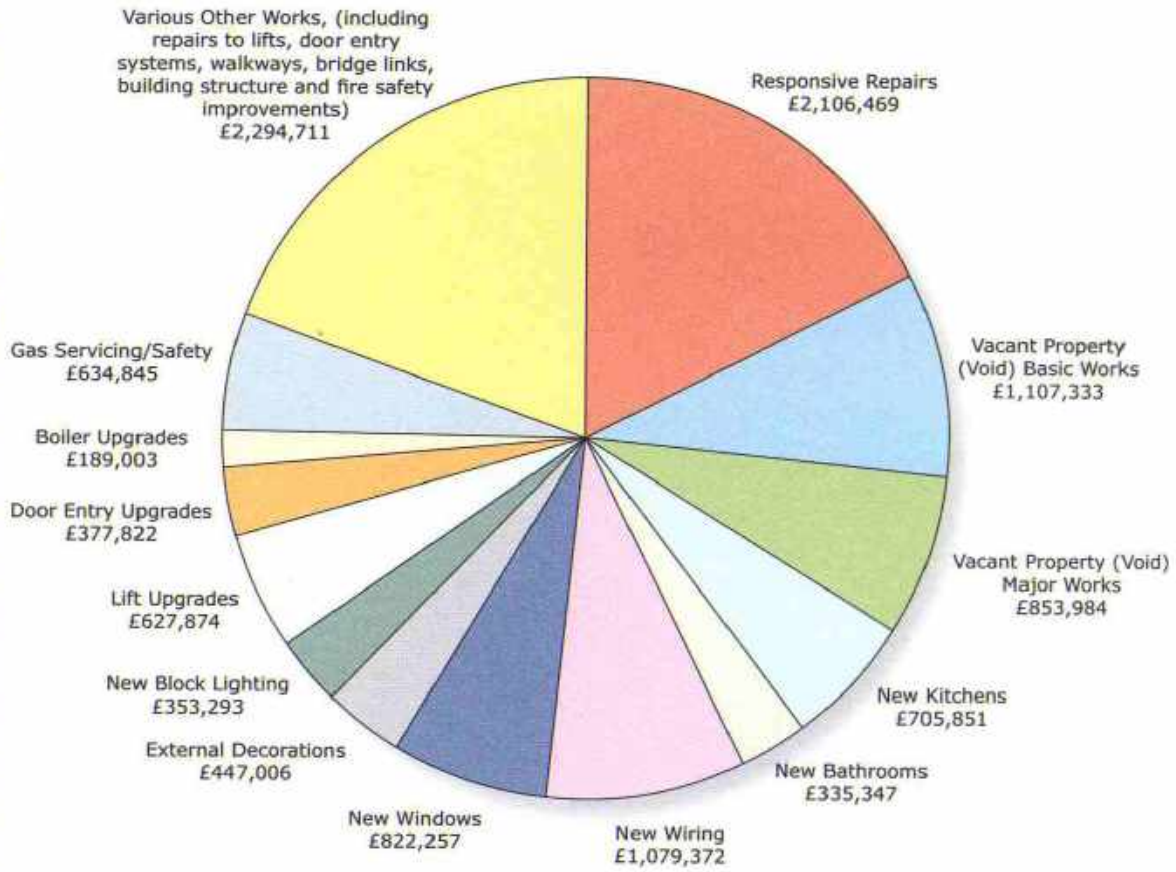
In 2009/10 we spent over £11.9 million on repairs and maintenance across all our homes. As part of our Decent Homes Standard we replaced 254 bathrooms and 313 kitchens, fitted 43 new boilers and installed double glazing in 257 homes.

This year:

- 99% of emergency reactive repairs were fixed on the first visit
- 98.4% of our properties had a gas safety check

If you need changes in your home because of a disability we can help - please contact us to find out more.

Repairs and maintenance costs



Home and repairs local offer

This local offer tells you what services to expect when we carry out repairs and maintenance.

We will:

- Consult with residents to reduce our repair response times
- Deliver enhanced standards for planned and internal modernisation works for kitchens, bathrooms, windows, doors and boilers
- Use feedback from our resident inspectors to improve cleaning and maintenance standards for empty homes, including deep cleaning for harder to let properties, painting front doors, frames, entrance hallways and staircases where required



Your community

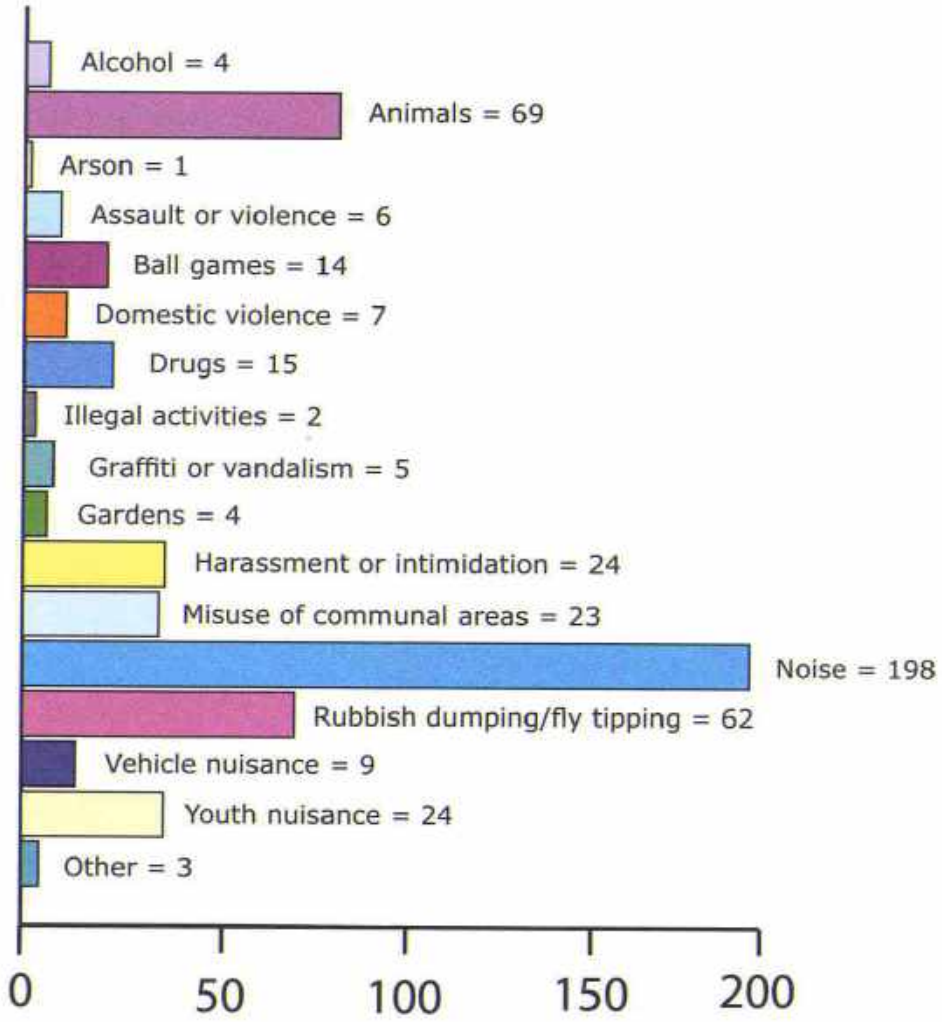
Our wardens work in partnership with many organisations including local authorities and police teams to help make our neighbourhoods better places to live.

As residents, you play the biggest role in helping us keep estates safe by reporting incidents of anti social behaviour to us and the police. Working together we can then deal with the issues that affect you.

This year the wardens have:

- made good neighbour visits to 196 residents
- reported 359 repairs for damaged lighting
- made 418 environmental nuisance reports

Anti-social behaviour reports



Community local offer

This local offer tells you what to expect when you report anti-social behaviour.

We will:

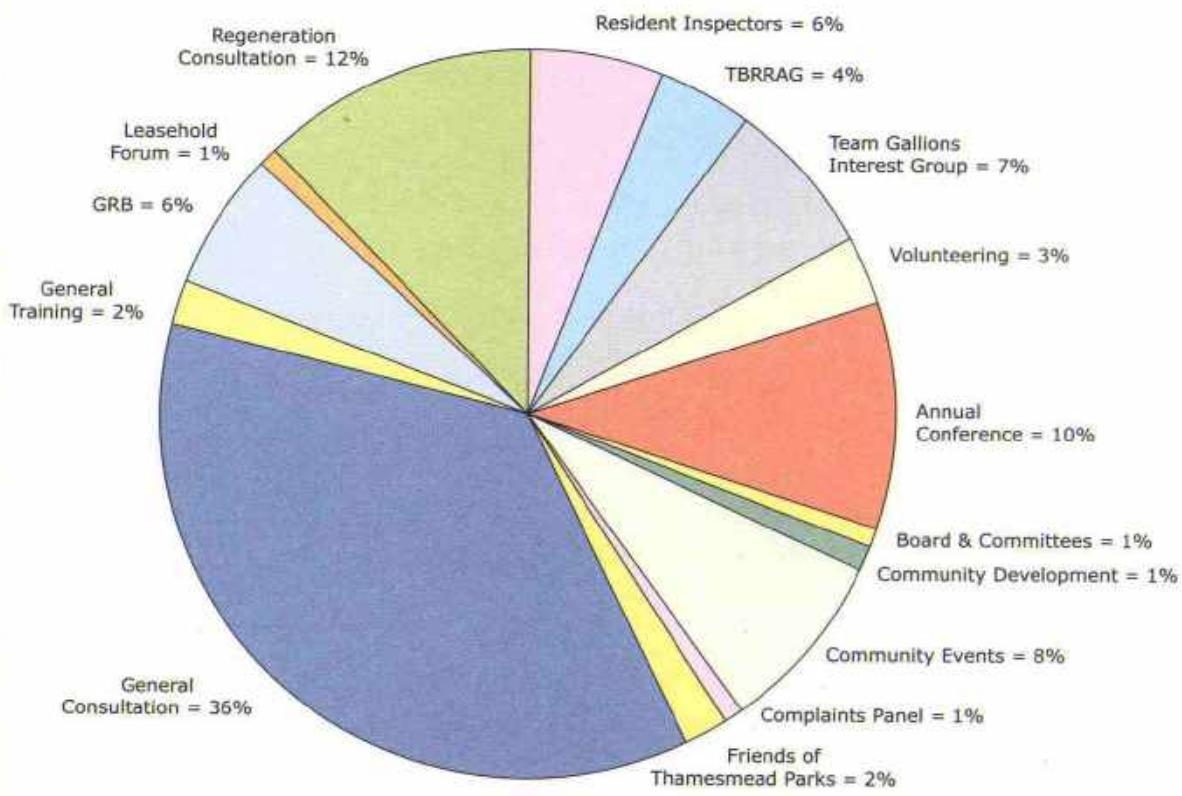
- Publish an up to date leaflet on our website and in reception about reporting anti-social behaviour (ASB) and the support we offer
- Offer a number of ways to report ASB - in person, in writing, by telephone, by email or online
- Take all ASB reports seriously and log them on our database
- Keep the identities of victims and witnesses confidential and deal with reports promptly
- Establish a preferred method of contact with residents
- Provide the name of the officer dealing with the case and a reference number
- Work with partner agencies at all levels, for example, police and local authorities
- Ensure staff have appropriate compulsory training relating to ASB
- Involve you in discussions about the action agreed to resolve issues
- Reward residents who support action or take positive steps to tackle anti-social behaviour
- Contact you within the published timescales

Getting involved

It's important to us that we involve you in what we are doing and changes to our service. We also like to hear from you with feedback about how we can improve. This year we engaged residents in the following activities (% represents split of number of residents per activity):

- We received 518 official complaints that were resolved through our complaints procedure, only one complaint went to the Housing Ombudsman Service
- Our quarterly residents magazine, Thamesview, is available through the post, to download on our website or by email
- We have answered more than 84,000 calls from our residents. Over 32% of those were regarding repairs
- We have organised 114 events which over 230 residents have attended to discuss our service and to meet socially

Resident involvement activities



Getting involved local offer



This offer sets out what you can expect when you get involved or communicate with us.

We will:

- Introduce a new resident engagement framework by November 2010
- Increase the number of ways residents can get involved with Gallions
- Use additional ways of engaging with residents, for example social networking and digital media
- Make sure residents have the opportunity to influence the services we provide
- Provide a clear range of support for engaged residents and resident groups including training, expenses and childcare
- Link levels of involvement to rewards and improvements for neighbourhoods
- Introduce a range of customer satisfaction surveys to actively monitor how residents view our services
- Introduce service standards to cover all key service areas and requests for information
- Invite residents that have complained to help us with service reviews when possible
- Agree improvement plans with residents where poor results are identified

Your neighbourhood

Team Gallions, our environmental services team, play a vital role in keeping your neighbourhood tidy. Working 365 days a year they provide services including rubbish and graffiti removal, grounds maintenance and management of parks and open spaces.

This year we have:

- Removed 77 illegally parked or dumped cars from our neighbourhoods
- Spent 2700 man hours removing graffiti from our estates
- Collected 1,700 tonnes of general household rubbish
- Collected almost 700 tonnes of dumped waste for recycling
- Spent £80,000 on pest control services
- Looked after the trees on our land at a cost of £146,000
- Spent £575,000 on external cleansing





Your neighbourhood local offer

This local offer includes information about what to expect when we clean communal areas and maintain public spaces like parks. We will:

- Clean and maintain lifts, lobbies, communal areas, chute areas to a grade B standard (see our full offer document for more details)
- Inspect and replace faulty communal light bulbs and report electrical faults for repair as required
- Remove litter and rubbish from paths, paved areas and external steps weekly (priority areas)
- Provide pest control services for communal areas
- Cut grass, clear leaves, maintain plants and shrubs, clean and maintain playgrounds and hard surfaced areas, jet wash public realm to a grade B standard
- Provide new or replacement planting
- Survey and inspect trees on a cyclical basis
- Prune trees to reduce health and safety risks
- Aim to remove unsafe, abandoned vehicles on Gallions land within 24 hours of report (weekdays)
- Consult with residents to reduce repair times for external paving
- Clear snow and ice and spread grit as required on Gallions land
- Work with partner agencies to improve waterways
- Provide a mobile patrol service for parks and open spaces daily (weekdays)
- Provide sports facilities on request
- Remove hypodermic needles and drug debris within 2 hours (weekdays)
- Remove bulk and dumped rubbish on Gallions land daily (weekdays)
- Empty dog waste bins weekly and remove dog waste from hard surfaces with 24 hours of report (weekdays)
- Remove pigeon paste from external areas on request

Reporting back to you

We will continue to monitor our services to make sure we are delivering them at the correct level. We are always looking at ways to improve our services and will consult with you about any changes or enhancements we plan to make.

We will monitor our services regularly and in a number of ways:

- Complete quality monitoring inspections
- Ask our resident groups for reports and feedback
- Review the complaints, comments and compliments we receive
- Carry out and analyse surveys and polls
- Examine external audit reports and recommendations
- Provide regular "local" reports to residents identifying performance against standards

View our full local offers report for more details about our monitoring procedures and proposed service improvements.





Our performance

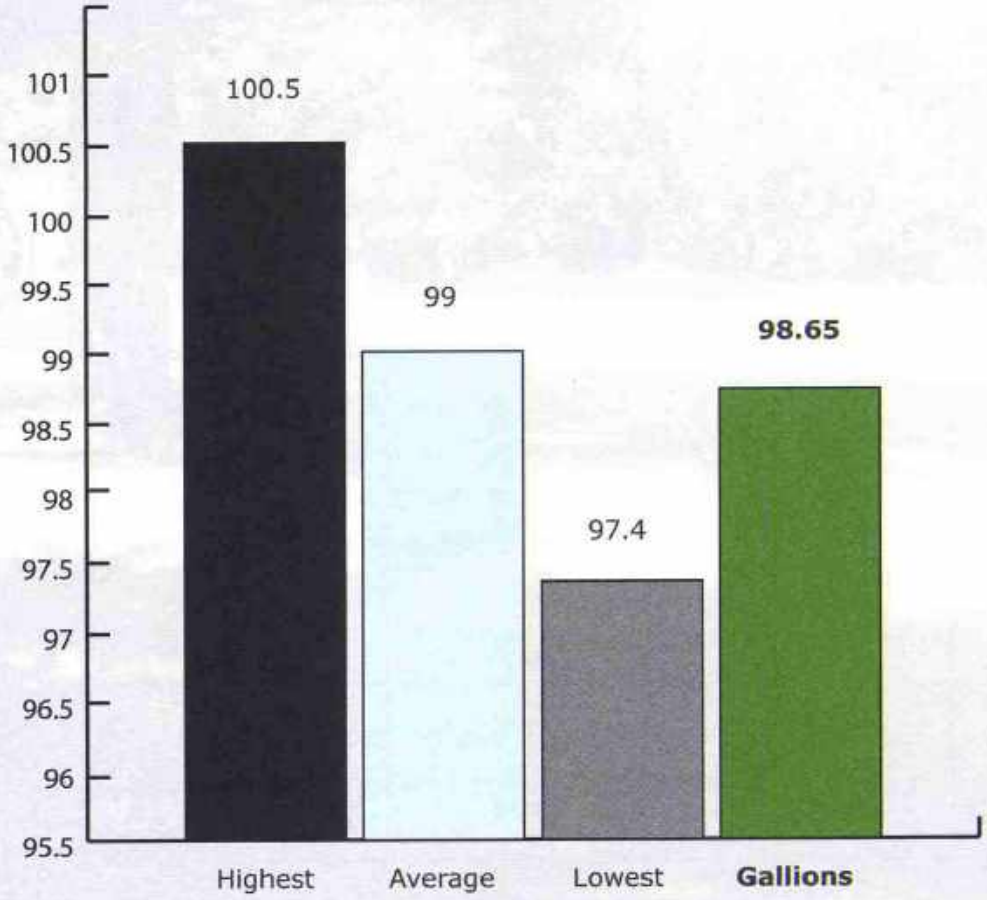
Every three years we carry out an in-depth survey which helps us see how satisfied you are with our services and compare ourselves against other organisations to make sure we are providing an excellent service. Here are our latest results:

	2007	2010	Difference
Residents very or fairly satisfied with the value for money of rent/service charge paid	69%	71%	▲ 2%
Residents very or fairly satisfied with the services provided by Gallions	77%	80%	▲ 3%
Residents very or fairly satisfied with the repairs and maintenance service	79%	80%	▲ 1%
Residents very or fairly satisfied with being kept informed by Gallions	84%	81%	▼ 3%
Residents very or fairly satisfied with residents views being taken into account by Gallions	60%	63%	▲ 3%
Residents very or fairly satisfied with the opportunities for involvement	47%	60%	▲ 13%
Residents very or fairly satisfied with their home	74%	77%	▲ 3%
Residents very or fairly satisfied with their neighbourhood	59%	64%	▲ 5%

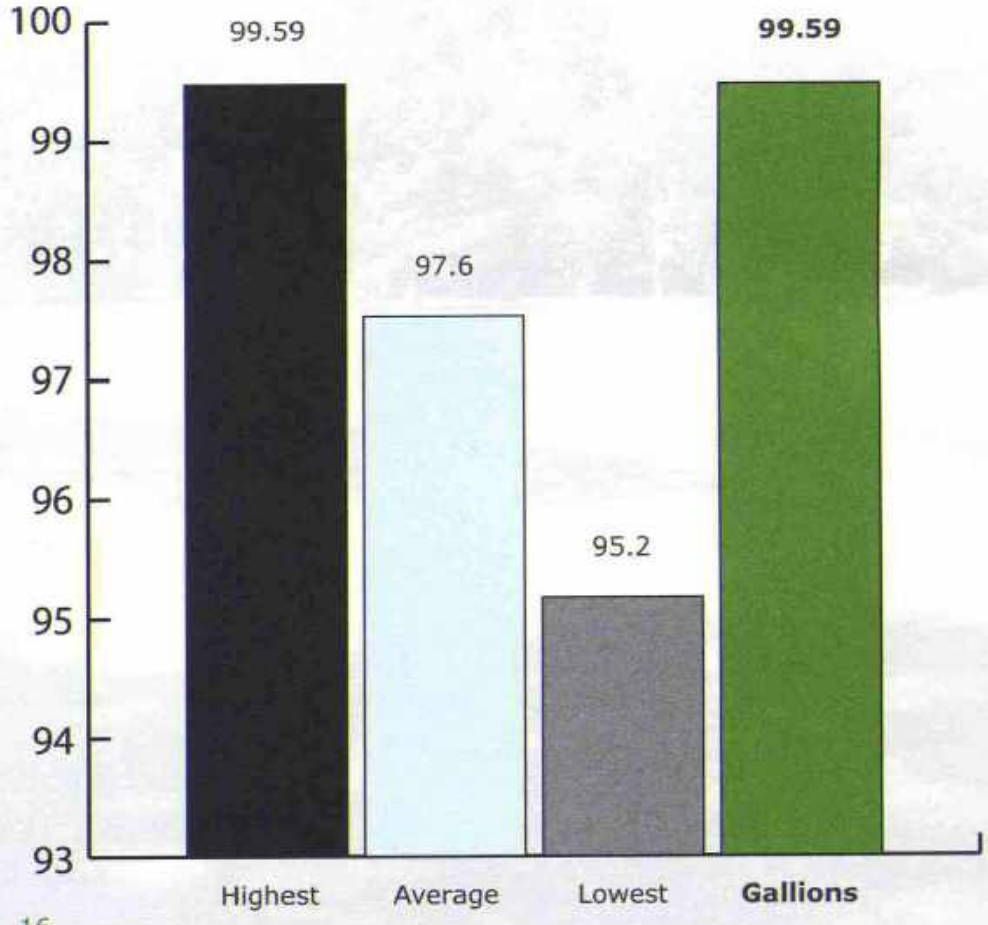
How we compare

We regularly compare our performance against other housing associations. These charts show you how well we are doing in a number of key areas, compared to 11 other local, similar sized housing associations.

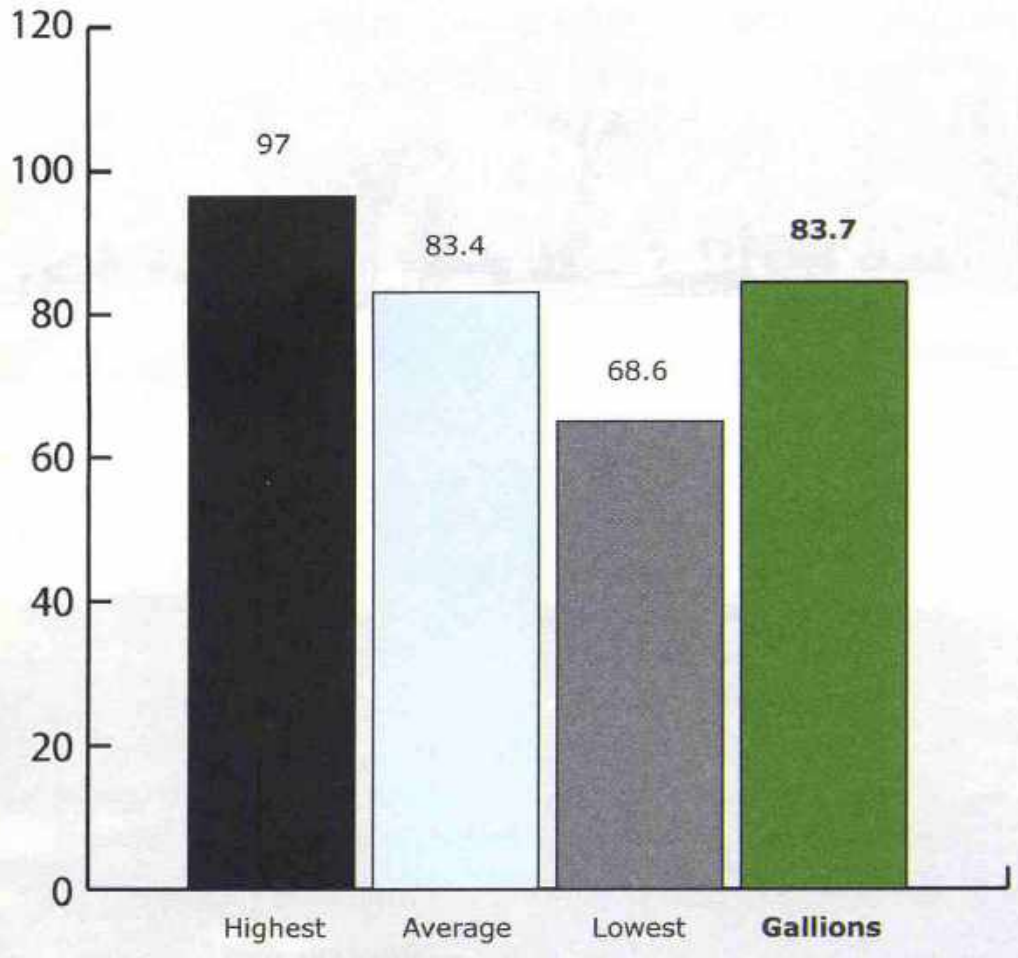
Rent collection rate (%)



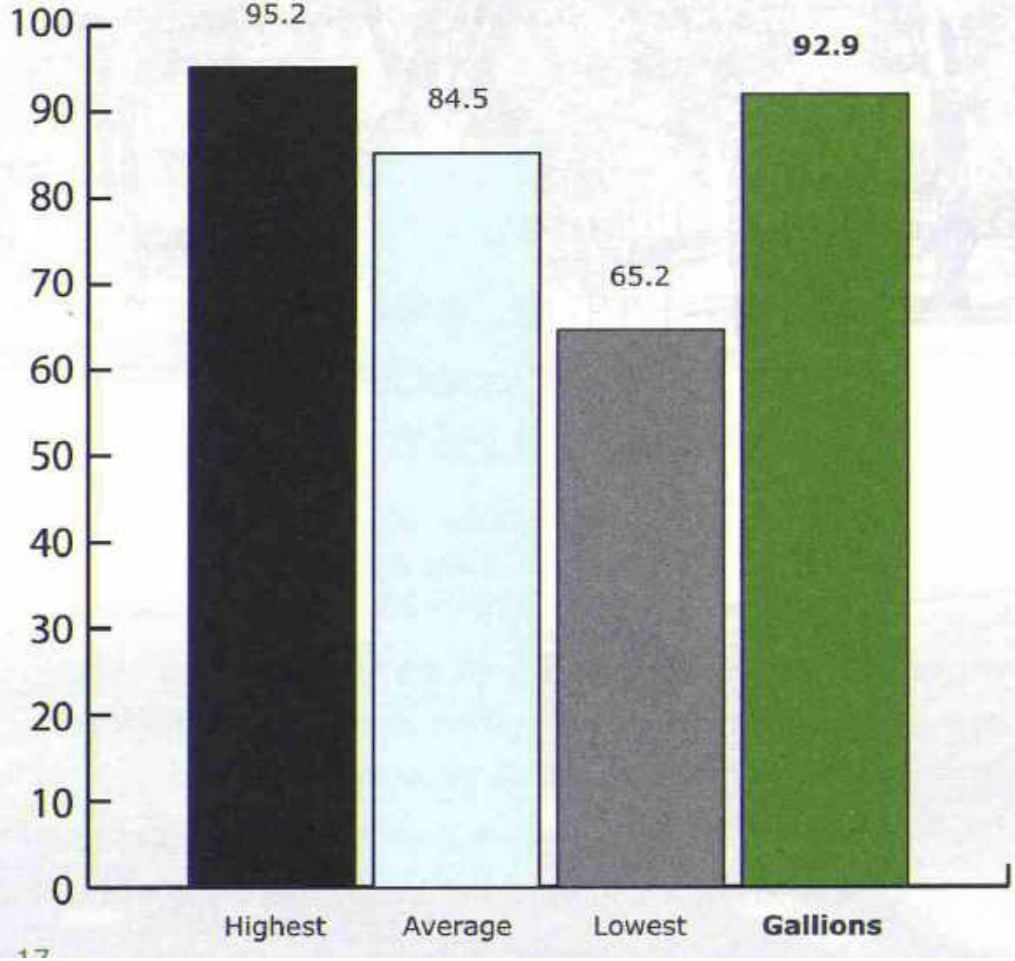
Emergency repairs completed on time (%)



Calls answered within target (%)



Complaints answered within 10 Days (%)



Get in touch

Please contact us if you would like more information about any of our services or would like to get involved with monitoring and improving what we do.

T: 0800 83 84 81 • **E:** communications@gallionsha.co.uk • **W:** www.gallionsha.co.uk
Freepost: Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR

We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like this Residents Annual Report translated into your own language or need an audio, large print or Braille version please contact us using the details above.

আমরা আমাদের সাথে যোগাযোগ সহজ করার জন্য একটি ব্যাপক অনুবাদ পরিষেবা প্রদান করে থাকি। আপনি যদি রেসিডেন্টস এনুয়াল রিভিউকে আপনার মাতৃভাষায় অনুবাদ হিসেবে পেতে চান বা একটি অডিও, বড় হরফের মুদ্রন বা ব্রেইল রূপ পেতে চান অনুগ্রহ করে আমাদের সাথে যোগাযোগ করুন।

我們提供廣泛的語言翻譯服務，令您能更方便地與我們交流。如果您需要將「年度居民評論」(Residents Annual Review) 翻譯為您所使用的語言，或需要音訊版本、大字體印刷版本或盲文版本，請與我們取得聯繫。

Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ biên dịch cho tất cả các loại ngôn ngữ để giúp quí vị dễ dàng liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn Bản Đánh giá Hàng năm về Cư dân này (Residents Annual Review) được dịch sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị hoặc quí vị cần một phiên bản khác bằng âm thanh, in khổ lớn hoặc Chữ nổi, xin hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi.

ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਪੱਤਰ-ਵਿਹਾਰ ਨੂੰ ਅਸਾਨ ਬਨਾਉਣ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਇੱਕ ਵਿਆਪਕ ਅਨੁਵਾਦ ਸੇਵਾ ਪੇਸ਼ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ। ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਨਿਵਾਸੀਆਂ ਦੀ ਸਲਾਨਾ ਸਮੀਖਿਆ ਦਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਵਿੱਚ ਅਨੁਵਾਦ ਕਰਵਾਉਣਾ ਚਾਹੋ ਜਾਂ ਤੁਹਾਨੂੰ ਆਡੀਓ, ਵੱਡੇ ਅੱਖਰਾਂ ਜਾਂ ਬ੍ਰੇਲ ਵਿੱਚ ਰੂਪਾਂਤਰ ਚਾਹੀਦਾ ਹੋਵੇ ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ।

A statement of the obligations of each Board Member to the Board and the Association is available on request.

Your feedback

This booklet has been produced in association with our Board, Gallions Residents Group and our Editorial Panel (which includes resident members). We would like to thank them for their contribution and feedback.

We will be getting more feedback when we launch our TSA offers at our residents conference in October. To give us your views please complete the form on the back of this booklet.

This booklet only includes a summary of the TSA offers and the work we will be doing over the coming year. A copy of the full TSA offer document is available to view on our website or a printed version is available on request.

Resident Approved

FSC Mixed Sources
Product group from well-managed forests and other controlled sources
www.fsc.org Cert no. SGS-COC-003351
© 1996 Forest Stewardship Council

Publication date: September 2010
Registered office: Heather Court, 6 Maidstone Road, Sidcup, Kent, DA14 5HH
Gallions Housing Association Limited is an exempt charity. Industrial and Provident Society, Registration number: IP28979R. Registered with the TSA, Registration No: L4274.

Feedback form

We hope that you have found this booklet helpful. Please give us your views and you could win a £50 shopping voucher!

Name:

Address:

Telephone:

Email:

1. What do you think of the level of information we have provided about our services:

Your home and repairs

Too much ☐ Just right ☐ Not enough ☐

Your community

Too much ☐ Just right ☐ Not enough ☐

Getting involved

Too much ☐ Just right ☐ Not enough ☐

Your neighbourhood

Too much ☐ Just right ☐ Not enough ☐

2. What sort of information would you like to receive from us? Tick all that apply.

Comparisons with other housing providers ☐
Detailed descriptions of services ☐
Statistics about performance ☐
Cost of services ☐

Other, please specify

3. Is there any other service information you would like to know about?

Return to: Resident Engagement, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR by 26 November 2010 to be entered into our prize draw.